From The Other Side

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/45645946.

Rating:
Not Rated

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Character:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Epilogue, Alternate Universe - Killing Eve (TV 2018) Fusion, Alternate Universe - Modern: No Powers, Married Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Married Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Summary

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Years. It's been years of radio silence, over a decade. Glimmer knew that goodbye outside the dance hall was going to be the last even if Adora pretended like it wasn't. Glimmer's seen true obsession now; there was no way Adora wasn't going to follow Catra to the ends of the earth. They're together. Back with the Horde because her mum still has her work on Catra's file in the background.

Catra's harder to track without Adora. It feels wrong to do on some level, but just because they didn't catch her before doesn't mean Catra isn't the wanted woman she always was - still their best way to the Horde. It scares her sometimes, the realisation that Adora saw everything Catra is, could do, and chose to love her the same way. She wasn't the person they all thought she was. It must've been a facade of some sort, but Glimmer can't get over how genuine Adora felt.

Adora seemed grown up to her when they met even though she was only a year older than her. With the clearer view of hindsight, she missed a lot, wrote things off or dismissed them entirely. Broken things in Adora's room paired with a bandage on one or both of Adora's hands. How uncomfortable she was in social situations, not shy, never that, no she'd scan crowds like someone was trying to hunt her down. The scars Glimmer never asked about, how angry she'd get when something broke routine - broke the careful picture she'd made, Glimmer now realises - before she managed to cram it back down.

Adora was never *happy*. That stung a lot at the beginning. Not when they graduated, not when they got the jobs they wanted, not at hers and Bow's wedding. Catra - Oksana, Charlotte and every other alias she's ever had - somehow did what they couldn't.

It takes a while for Glimmer to pin down hits that she's sure are Catra's. She's back to being careful like before, rarely flashy

without Adora to taunt and…impress. (She tries not to think about it too hard.)

Catra stays elusive for years. Better targets appear, the unit moves on. And then even what flimsy evidence she did have drops off. Nothing even close. There's some weak maybes and that's it. Glimmer wants to believe they're alive, somewhere safe. If she hadn't seen first hand how *bright* Catra made her, she would wish Adora to be without her. It would be better for her.

It's an innocuous letter, just an address and her name. There's no message, just a photo. When she just stands there staring, Bow comes over, leaves their second baby asleep on the sofa where he was sitting, their firstborn is at the kitchen table doing his school work. Bow's hand is gentle on her shoulder, but he freezes just the same when he sees it.

They're older in the photo, of course they are, but that means they're *alive*. Together, somewhere. Catra and Adora, both in red, holding each other in some non-distinct building and looking as in love as Glimmer's ever seen anyone look. It takes her a minute, and she'll never be able to process what she feels when she sees it, in fact she'll most likely lock this away in some box and shove it under the bed with the rest of Adora's ghost; Adora is there, hair loose the way it never was, and Catra is cradling her face, wedding ring glinting on her left hand.

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